

MODULE–II ASSIGNMENT 1

Exploratory Research – Problem Formulation & Data Collection Planning

★ THE OPPORTUNITY

In Karnataka, tech companies are slowly expanding into emerging cities like Mysuru, Hubballi-Dharwad, and Mangalore. This shift could create local job opportunities and reduce the migration of students to Bengaluru for their careers. It also has the potential to impact families who can have children working closer to home, and local communities that may benefit from the resulting economic growth and decentralisation. However, many students are unsure/unaware of the potential of jobs in these new tech hubs. The purpose of this study is to explore how students perceive this shift and what factors influence their willingness to work in these cities.

★ RESEARCH DESIGN

1. To begin, I'll conduct a brief policy analysis by reviewing secondary sources like government policies and news articles to understand more about the tech decentralisation in Karnataka.
2. I also plan to do some field observation by making short field visits to local college campuses, IT parks and job fairs.
3. For primary research, I'll survey with final-year students and recent graduates to understand their motivations and concerns.
4. By combining these findings, I hope to understand how these new prospects are perceived and how they will affect stakeholders and communities.

★ SAMPLING AND DATA COLLECTION PLAN

Purposive sampling can be used to target final-year students and recent graduates in the tech field across Bengaluru, Mysuru, Hubballi-Dharwad, and Mangalore. For diversity, I'll use stratified sampling too, selecting participants based on city and field of study. If needed, I will use snowball sampling to reach underrepresented groups. Data will be collected through an offline and online survey using forms shared via social media groups, college placement cells, etc.

Survey questions:

1. *Where do you study/live?*
2. *What is your academic/professional status?*
3. *Which field are you studying or working in?*
4. *Have you heard about tech companies opening offices in cities outside Bengaluru (like Mysuru, Hubballi, Dharwad, Mangalore, etc)?*
5. *If you got a job in one of these cities, how confident would you be in taking it?*

6. *What are some thoughts that come to your mind about tech jobs in such emerging hubs? (wrt peer group, opportunities, etc)*
7. *What makes you hesitant to accept a job in such emerging places?*
8. *What would make such jobs more suitable for you?*
good salary/ cheaper living/ better work-life balance/ good company name/ career growth/ proximity to family/ relocation help/ others....

★ ANALYSE

I would look to quantify the perception of such jobs and the overall willingness to accept them. This can be compared across groups/cities to identify differences. For example, are people more willing to shift to Mysore as compared to Hubballi, and why? I'd also check if willingness is directly proportional to awareness and incentives. Popular motivators and concerns can be identified to understand what influences such a shift. It would help if the data showed a clear majority so we can take appropriate actions.

★ REPORTING

The final result of this study would be a report highlighting the ratio of people willing to make this shift, visuals indicating how people currently view such roles and what they expect as incentives to consider taking such jobs. These findings can be shown separately for each domain, geography, or stakeholder type. Finally, key insights can be provided to companies, colleges and the government to push this shift.

References

1. <https://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/city/bengaluru/karnataka-tech-push-new-it-policy-announced-rs-50000-incentive-to-shift-tech-talent-beyond-bengaluru/articleshow/125426940.cms>
2. <https://www.ijnep.com/post/research-design-process>
3. <https://sago.com/en/resources/blog/different-types-of-sampling-techniques-in-qualitative-research/>

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Hopefully, Bangalore traffic catches a break.